Brightloop renewal: negotiation plan

Enterprise plan · €36,000/yr · renews 14 Dec 2026 · champion Sam (automation engineer) · procurement Priya · prepared Tue 20 Oct

SITUATION

- **Asks:** 25% off, net 60, no auto-renewal, 3-month termination for convenience, smaller plan.
- **Real drivers:** a real budget cut; procurement needs a visible win; two slow support escalations.
- **Small dip:** executions down only 10%. Sam values the product.
- **Value first, with the CSM:** before any price, we show what n8n runs for them (workflows, executions, hours saved) and what replacing it would cost. Concessions follow value, never replace it.
- **Their alternative:** the free self-hosted Community edition. It loses SSO, environments/Git, log streaming and SLA support, and adds hosting work.

THE NUMBERS

Renewal value	€36,000/yr (5% uplift already included)
List path	€36,000 (yr 1) · €37,800 (yr 2, indexed 5%)
Their ask	€27,000 = 25% off. Needs VP CS.
Key question	**Is the problem cash, or this year's cost line?** The answer decides which option I lead with.

TARGET OUTCOME: TWO OPTIONS, PROCUREMENT CHOOSES

	1. Ramp: keep the plan, pay annually (target)	**2. Downsize + lock: pay upfront** (budget option)
Plan	Current Enterprise plan	Enterprise, lower execution allowance sized to real usage (assumed ~20% lower)
Price	Yr 1 **€32,400** (−10%) · Yr 2 **€35,910** (indexed, −5%)	**€28,800/yr, locked** for 2 or 3 years
Contract value	**€68,310**: about 5% below staying at €36,000 a year	€57,600 (2 yrs) · €86,400 (3 yrs)
Concession	7.4% vs list path → **Finance**	List price; waived uplift 2.4% / 4.8% → Finance only for net 60
Payment	Annual, net 30 or 45	Upfront, **net 60**
Both include	Top support tier · no downgrade during the term · auto-renewal clause applies only after the committed term, plus a 90-day reminder from us · signed by **30 Nov** (offers expire then)	

WALK-AWAY POSITION

- **Never:** a termination-for-convenience right, or removing the auto-renewal clause.
- **Current plan floor:** no more than 12% total discount vs list. That's a 2-year total of at least **€64,944** (Finance's limit).
- **Below that:** downsize at list price. Honest contraction beats a discount that resets the price for 220 other renewals.
- **VP escalation only** for something new: a 3-year term on the current plan, or a public case study.

> **In reserve (ramp only):** a downgrade buffer of up to 10% of the execution allowance at the yr-2 anniversary, 60 days' notice, pre-approved by the VP. Used only if Priya pushes again for an exit right. Even if used in full, they pay 12.3% less than the list path over 2 years.

WHAT I GIVE AND WHAT I GET

I give	Only if
Year-1 relief (ramp)	2-year term, signed by 30 Nov
Price lock from year 2	Payment upfront
Net 60	Payment upfront
Top support tier	Multi-year term + joint support review
Downgrade buffer	Termination-right demand dropped
Auto-renewal only after term + reminder	Clause stays in the order form

Free: support root-cause review, exec sponsor call, CSM usage-optimisation session. **Also ask for:** one named signatory and a reference or case study.

WHO I INVOLVE, BEFORE THE CALL

Finance	Pre-approve the ramp (7.4%), net 60 with upfront payment, the 3-year lock and room up to 12%.
VP Customer Success	Pre-approve the downgrade buffer; heads-up that €36k is at risk.
Legal	Wording for auto-renewal after the term, the buffer clause, and declining the termination right.
CSM	Builds the value summary with me from usage data and presents it on the call; sizes the lower allowance; owns Sam and the success plan for the next term.
Support lead	Root-cause review of both escalations by 30 Oct; confirm the top support tier and whether it's a paid add-on.
My manager	Weekly status until signed.

Fictional figures from the challenge brief. The lower-allowance price (€28,800) is an assumption, to be replaced with the real list price of the tier that fits their usage.